

GINKGO

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GINKGOACEAE

See also CONIFERS.

G. biloba (Maidenhair tree) illus. p.97. ‘**Saratoga**’, is an upright conical tree. H to 40ft (12m), S 30ft (10m). Has variably shaped, dark green leaves, that give a lacy effect. ‘**Troll**’, H and S to 3ft (1m), is very slow-growing and ideal for a container. Z5–9

GLADIOLUS

SYN. HOMOGLOSSUM, ACIDERANTHERA

IRIDACEAE

Genus of corms, each producing a spike of funnel-shaped flowers and a fan of erect, narrow, linear or sword-shaped leaves on the basal part of the flower stem. Suitable for cutting or for planting in mixed borders; most hybrids are also good for exhibition. Needs a sunny and fertile, well-drained site. Plant 4–6in (10–15cm) deep and the same distance apart in spring. Water well in summer and support tall cultivars with canes. Where marginally hardy, lift corms in fall, cut off stems, and dry in a frost-free but cool place. Pot spring-flowering plants in fall and place in a cool greenhouse; after flowering, dry off corms during summer months and repot in fall.

Propagate by seed or by removal of young cormlets from parent. Seed sown in early spring in a cool greenhouse will take 2–3 years to flower and may not breed true to type. Store cormlets, removed after lifting, in frost-free conditions and plant out 2in (5cm) deep in spring; lift in winter as for mature corms. They will flower in 1–2 years.

While in store, corms may be attacked by various rots. Protect sound, healthy corms by dusting with a fungicide or soaking in a fungicide solution before drying; store in an airy, cool, frost-free place. Gladiolus scab causes blotches on leaves; gladiolus yellows shows as yellowing stripes on leaves, which then die; in both cases destroy affected corms. As a preventive measure, always plant healthy corms in a new site each year. See also feature panel p.384.

Gladiolus hybrids

Most hybrids are derived from *G. x hortulanus*. All have stiff leaves, 8–20in (20–50cm) long, ranging from pale willow-green or steely blue-green to almost bottle-green. All are good for flower arranging. They are divided into Grandiflorus, Primulinus, and Nanus Groups.

Grandiflorus Group produces long, densely packed spikes of funnel-shaped flowers, with ruffled, thick-textured petals or plain-edged, thin-textured ones. Giant-flowered hybrids have a bottom flower of over 5½in (14cm) across (flower head is 26–32in [65–80cm] long); large-flowered 4½–5½in (11–14cm) across (flower head 2–3ft [60cm–1m] long); medium-flowered 3½–4½in (9–11cm) across (flower head 24–32in [60–80cm] long); small-flowered 2½–3½in (6–9cm) across (flower head 20–28in [50–70cm] long); miniature-

flowered 1½–2½in (3.5–6cm) across (flower head 16–24in [40–60cm] long).

Primulinus Group has fairly loose spikes of plain-edged, funnel-shaped flowers, 1½–3in (3.5–7cm) across, each with a strongly hooded, upper petal over the stigma and anthers. Flower heads are 1ft (30cm) or more long.

Nanus Group produces 2 or 3 slender spikes, with loosely arranged flowers, s1½–2in (4–5cm) across. Flower heads are 9–14in (22–35cm) long.

G. ‘Amanda Mahy’. Nanus Group gladiolus. H 32in (80cm), S 3–4in (8–10cm). Produces spikes of up to 7 salmon-pink flowers, with lip tepals flecked violet and white, in early summer. Z8–10

G. ‘Amsterdam’. Grandiflorus Group, giant-flowered gladiolus. H 5½ft (1.7m), S 1ft (30cm). Spikes of up to 27 slightly upward-facing, finely ruffled, white flowers are produced in late summer. Good for exhibition. Z8–10

G. ‘Beauty of Holland’. Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 5½ft (1.7m), S 6in (15cm). Produces spikes of up to 27 ruffled, pink-margined, white flowers in midsummer. Good for exhibition. Z8–10

G. ‘Bernadette’. Nanus Group gladiolus. H to 28in (70cm), S 3–4in (8–10cm). Bears spikes of red-and-yellow bicolored flowers in summer. Z8–10

G. ‘Black Jack’. Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 3ft (90cm), S 3in (8cm). Bears spikes of black-edged, dark maroon flowers in summer. Z8–10

G. ‘Black Lash’. Grandiflorus Group, small-flowered gladiolus. H 4½ft (1.3m), S 6–8in (15–20cm). Bears spikes of up to 25 lightly ruffled, deep black-rose flowers, with pointed, slightly reflexed petals, from late summer to early fall. Z8–10

G. blandus. See *G. carneus*. **G. blandus var. carneus**. See *G. carneus*. **G. ‘Blue Frost’** (illus. p.384). Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 4ft (1.2m), S 6in (15cm). In midsummer, bears spikes of white flowers with ruffled, lilac edges and darker purple eyes. Z8–10

G. byzantinus. See *G. communis* subsp. *byzantinus*.

G. callianthus. See *G. murielae*. **G. cardinalis**. Summer-flowering corm. H to 4ft (1.2m), S 4–6in (10–15cm). Arching stem bears a spike of up to 12 widely funnel-shaped flowers, each 3in (8cm) long and bright red with spear-shaped, white marks on lower 3 petals. Z8–10

G. carneus, syn. *G. blandus*, *G. blandus var. carneus*. Spring-flowering corm. H 8–16in (20–40cm), S 3–4in (8–10cm). Stem bears a loose spike of 3–12 widely funnel-shaped, white or pink flowers, 1½–2½in (4–6cm) long, marked on lower petals with darker red or yellow blotches. Z8–10

G. ‘Charmer’. Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 5½ft (1.7m), S 6in (15cm). In early and mid-summer, produces spikes of up to 27 strongly ruffled, almost translucent, light pink flowers. Good for exhibition. Z8–10

G. ‘Charming Lady’. Nanus Group gladiolus. H 28in (70cm), S 3in (8cm). Bears spikes of pink flowers, with pale lilac throats, from early to midsummer. Z8–10

G. ‘Columbine’ (illus. p.384). Primulinus Group, small-flowered gladiolus. H 3ft (90cm), S 3in (8cm). In early summer produces spikes of light carmine-rose flowers with creamy-white throats. Z8–10 **G. x colvillii ‘The Bride’**. See *G. ‘The Bride’*.

G. communis subsp. byzantinus, syn. *G. byzantinus*, illus. p.410.

G. ‘Côte d’Azur’. Grandiflorus Group, giant-flowered gladiolus. H 5½ft (1.7m), S 6in (15cm). Bears spikes of up to 23 ruffled, mid-blue flowers, with pale blue throats, in early summer. Good for exhibition. Z8–10

G. dalenii, syn. *G. natalensis*, *G. psittacinus*. Vigorous, summer-flowering corm. H to 5ft (1.5m), S 4–6in (10–15cm). Produces up to 14 red, yellow-orange, yellow or greenish-yellow flowers, 3–5in (8–12cm) long, each with a hooded, upper petal and often flecked or streaked red. Z8–10

G. ‘Drama’ (illus. p.384). Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 5½ft (1.7m), S 10–12in (25–30cm). In late summer, produces spikes of up to 26 lightly ruffled, deep watermelon-pink flowers with red-marked, yellow throats. Superb for exhibition. Z8–10

G. ‘Dutch Mountain’. Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 5½ft (1.7m), S 6in (15cm). In midsummer, produces spikes of up to 25 slightly ruffled, white flowers with small green marks in the throats. Good for exhibition. Z8–10 **G. ‘Esta Bonita’**. Grandiflorus Group, giant-flowered gladiolus. H 5½ft (1.7m), S 1ft (30cm). Produces spikes of up to 24 apricot-orange flowers, slightly darker toward petal edges, in late summer. Good for exhibition. Z8–10

G. ‘Firestorm’. Grandiflorus Group, miniature-flowered gladiolus. H 3½ft (1.1m), S 3–4in (8–10cm). Spikes of up to 22 loosely spaced, ruffled, vivid scarlet flowers, with yellowish-white flecks on the outer tepals, are produced in early summer. Is good for exhibition. Z8–10

G. ‘Flevo Bambino’. Grandiflorus Group, medium-flowered gladiolus. H 2ft (60cm), S 3in (8cm). From late summer to early fall bears spikes of pale yellow, purple-throated flowers. Z8–10

G. ‘Georgette’. Grandiflorus Group, small-flowered gladiolus. H 4ft (1.2m), S 3–4in (8–10cm). Produces spikes of up to 22 slightly ruffled, yellow-suffused, orange flowers, with large lemon-yellow throats, in midsummer. Good for exhibition. Z8–10

G. ‘Halley’. Nanus Group gladiolus. H 3ft (1m), S 3–4in (8–10cm). In early summer produces spikes bearing up to 7 white-flushed, pale yellow flowers, each with bright red marks in the throats. Z8–10 **G. ‘Her Majesty’** (illus. p.384).

Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 46in (115cm), S 6in (15cm). Produces spikes of sky-blue flowers, with much paler throats, in midsummer. Z8–10 **G. ‘Ice Cap’**. Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 5½ft (1.7m), S 10–12in (25–30cm). Produces spikes of up to 27 heavily ruffled, ice-white flowers from late summer to early fall. Z8–10

G. ‘Impressive’ (illus. p.384). Nanus Group gladiolus. H 28in (70cm), S 3in (8cm). Spikes of pale pink flowers, with hot

pink markings, are borne in early summer. Z8–10

G. italicus, syn. *G. segetum*. Early summer-flowering corm. H to 3ft (1m), S 4–6in (10–15cm). Bears a loose spike of up to 20 pinkish-purple flowers, 1½–2in (4–5cm) long, and has a fan of erect, sword-shaped leaves from the basal part of stem. Z8–10

G. ‘Magistral’. Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 6ft (1.8m), S 6in (15cm). Produces spikes of up to 24 ruffled, oyster-white flowers, with magenta lines, in midsummer. Good for exhibition. Z8–10 **G. ‘Morning Gold’** (illus. p.384).

Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 3ft (1m), S 4in (10cm). Spikes of green-tinted, golden-yellow flowers are produced from midsummer to early fall. Z8–10

G. murielae, syn. *Acidanthera bicolor* var. *murielae*, *A. murielae*, *G. callianthus*. (illus. p.383).

G. natalensis. See *G. dalenii*. **G. ‘Nova Lux’** (illus. p.384). Grandiflorus Group, giant-flowered gladiolus. H 3ft (1m), S 6in (15cm). Spikes of clear yellow flowers are borne in midsummer. Z8–10 **G. ‘Nymph’** (illus. p.384). Nanus Group gladiolus. H 28in (70cm), S 3in (8cm). In early summer produces spikes of creamy-white flowers, with teardrop-shaped, pink-edged markings on the lower petals. Z8–10 **G. ‘Oscar’** (illus. p.384). Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 3ft (1m), S 6in (15cm). Produces spikes of velvety-red flowers in midsummer. Z8–10

G. papilio illus. p.395. **Purpleoauratus Group** (syn. *G. purpleoauratus*) is a summer- or fall-flowering corm. H to 3ft (1m), S 6in (15cm). Has greenish-yellow flowers, with lower petals each blotched red-brown at the throat. Z8–10

G. ‘Passos’. Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 4ft (1.2m), S 6in (15cm). Spikes of purple-flecked, pale lilac to white flowers, with dark purple throats, are produced in midsummer. Z8–10

G. ‘Peter Pears’ (illus. p.384). Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 5½ft (1.7m), S 14in (35cm). In late summer, has spikes of up to 26 apricot-salmon flowers with red throat marks. Excellent for exhibition. Z8–10 **G. ‘Pink Lady’**. Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 5ft (1.5m), S 10–12in (25–30cm). Has spikes of up to 25 lightly ruffled, deep rose-pink flowers, with large, white throats, in late summer and early fall. Z8–10

G. psittacinus. See *G. dalenii*. **G. ‘Purple Flora’** (illus. p.384). Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 3ft (1m), S 6in (15cm). Produces spikes of rich deep purple flowers, with paler lilac markings, in midsummer. Z8–10

G. purpleoauratus. See *G. papilio* Purpleoauratus Group.

G. ‘Rose Supreme’. Grandiflorus Group, giant-flowered gladiolus. H 5½ft (1.7m), S 10–12in (25–30cm). Spikes of up to 24 rose-pink flowers, flecked and streaked darker pink toward petal tips, and with cream throats, are produced in late summer. Z8–10

G. ‘Royal Dutch’. Grandiflorus Group, large-flowered gladiolus. H 5½ft (1.7m),